

006. Chapter 2 Verses 17-18

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 2.17

अविनाशि तु तद्विद्धि येन सर्वमिदं ततम् ।
विनाशमव्ययस्यास्य न कश्चित्कर्तुमर्हति ॥ 17 ॥

avināśi tu tadviddhi
yena sarvamidam tatam |
vināśamavyayasyāsyā
na kaścitkartumarhati ||

◆ avināśi – imperishable; tu – indeed; tat – that; viddhi – know; ◆ yena – by which; sarvam idam – all this; tatam – pervaded; ◆ vināśam – destruction; avyayasya – of the immutable; asya – of this; ◆ na kaścit – no one; kartum arhati – is able to do.

(O Arjuna!) Know that Atma by which the whole universe is pervaded is indestructible. No one can cause the destruction of the imperishable.

VERSE 2.18

अन्तवन्त इमे देहा नित्यस्योक्ताः शरीरिणः ।
अनाशिनोऽप्रमेयस्य तस्माद्युध्यस्व भारत ॥ 18 ॥

antavanta ime dehā
nityasyoktāḥ śarīriṇaḥ |
anāśino'prameyasya
tasmādyudhyasva bhārata ||

♦ antavantaḥ – having an end; ime – these; dehāḥ – bodies; ♦ nityasya – of the eternal; uktāḥ – are said; śarīriṇaḥ – of the embodied soul; ♦ anāśinaḥ – of the indestructible; aprameyasya – of the immeasurable; ♦ tasmāt – therefore; yudhyasva – fight; bhārata – O Bharata.

**These bodies which belong to the real imperishable,
unknowable Atma are said to be subject to an end; therefore
fight, O Arjuna!**